

TEJASWI ERATTU TAJ

Seattle WA | tjerattu@gmail.com | <https://tejaswierattuwebsite.vercel.app/> | Security Engineer

EDUCATION

University of Washington: BS in Informatics
Focus area: Software Engineering + Cyber Security

Expected Graduation date: 2028
GPA: 3.8/4.0

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Engineer, Palana

June 2026 – Present

- Conducted threat modeling across 10+ product surfaces using STRIDE methodology, cataloguing distinct threats and mapping trust boundaries across the mobile, backend, and Firebase architecture
- Identified a confirmed privilege-escalation vulnerability in session/identity handling and drove remediation with the engineering team prior to deployment
- Built security documentation and risk-mitigation control mappings covering 7+ categories of sensitive data (location, PII, auth, admin access), aligned to STRIDE and CIA triad frameworks
- Evaluated and piloted 2 static analysis tools (Semgrep, npm audit) to replace CodeQL in the CI/CD pipeline after a private-repo migration broke existing scanning
- Ran manual penetration testing with Burp Suite against API and WebSocket endpoints to assess authorization and data-exposure risk

Machine Learning Manager, Cyber Minds Non-Profit

Jan 2024 - June 2024

- Built and deployed a Python (scikit-learn) chatbot integrated via Firebase, handling 100+ monthly user interactions and cutting average response time by 60%
- Led a 5-person team using Agile sprints (GitHub Projects) to integrate a TensorFlow-based ML model into production 2 weeks ahead of schedule
- Trained a scikit-learn classification model on student interaction data to personalize an 8-module cybersecurity curriculum, boosting engagement scores by 35%

AI Trainer and Tester, Apollo AI

May 2024 - May 2025

- Trained and evaluated 5 classification/regression models (TensorFlow) for Saturn AI's grading engine, improving accuracy by 40% for 50+ K-12 students
- Optimized model performance cutting average response time from 8s to 3s

Backend Developer, Kerela Association of Washington

May 2025 – Dec 2025

- Migrated 2,800+ member records to WordPress via custom PHP/MySQL ETL scripts, cutting manual data entry time by 75%
- Built custom WordPress plugins (PHP, MySQL, JavaScript/AJAX) for real-time member management and automated daily backups via WP-Cron
- Streamlined reporting with PHP-driven exportable data fields, cutting monthly report generation from hours to minutes

PM Intern, iLink Digital

June 2024 - Aug 2024

- Collaborated across 3 client teams to test 20+ AI automation tools (Zapier, UiPath) and build Power BI dashboards, informing delivery decisions for live projects
- Coordinated with engineers, PMs, and C-suite stakeholders through 20+ Agile ceremonies (Jira, Microsoft Teams), aligning cross-functional priorities across 3 client engagements

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, SQL, PHP

Security: Threat Modeling, Vulnerability Assessment, Network Security Fundamentals, Zero Trust Architecture, IAM/Access Control, Cryptography Fundamentals, Incident Response, Responsible AI/AI Risk Management, Security+, AWS AI Practitioner

ML/AI: Classification, Regression, Hyperparameter Tuning (Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn)

Tools: Git, MySQL, Power BI, Power Query, WordPress, Jira, Confluence, Agile/Scrum

Cloud/Infra: AWS, Azure, GCP (fundamentals), Docker (familiarity), CI/CD concepts

PROJECTS

GitHub Extension

Jan 2026 - Jun 2026

- Built a pre-commit secret detection pipeline (TypeScript, regex) scanning staged diffs across 6 credential pattern types, blocking exposed secrets before they reached version control
- Designed a real-time risk classification engine (Git CLI, TypeScript) that scored every Git action low/medium/high risk, adding confirmation gates to previously unguarded destructive operations
- Implemented a command preview/confirmation flow across 6 core Git workflows using the VS Code Extension API, eliminating blind execution of AI-generated Git commands
- Developed a branch overlap detection system (Git diff parsing) that cross-referenced file-level changes across active branches for teams of 2-10, flagging conflicts before merge

LEADERSHIP AND CREDENTIALS

- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Malayalam (Native), Spanish (Elementary)
- **Certifications:** AWS AI Practitioner, Security +
- **Other Leadership:** Women in Informatics Finance Director (6 months – present), Accountability and Hopeful Fridays Software Engineering Lead(3 months – present), Martial Arts Head Instructor (3 years - 2024), Coding Instructor (3 years - 2025)